the Commonwealth Bank Series, held in Australia in 2012. In that case, his captain, Virender Sehwag, withdrew the appeal after consulting the umpires, Paul Reiffel and Billy Bowden.

Buttler was also the victim in 2014, when run out by Sri Lanka's Sachithra Senanayake in a decisive one-day international at Edgbaston. His captain, Angelo Mathews, reinforced the appeal because Jos had been warned about backing up in the previous over. We lost by six wickets with ten balls remaining. I top-scored with 56 out of 219, which didn't seem terribly important at the time.

Imposing ethical behaviour, or strengthening a sense of fair play, is a tricky element of captaincy. New Zealand's dressing-room door was slammed in the face of Paul Collingwood when he failed to withdraw England's appeal for Grant Elliott's run out after a mid-pitch collision with Ryan Sidebottom in the fourth one-day international at the Oval in 2008.

The Kiwis were incensed, arguing that Ryan had run directly at the batsman as he attempted a quick single. Daniel Vettori, their captain, later apologized for gesticulating and swearing from the balcony when his team won off the last ball of the match. They initially blanked Colly, who was contrite in an almost impossible situation. I wasn't playing, but it was an emotionally charged game. He was under pressure from the umpires and his own players.

At the very most, he had twenty seconds to make a decision that had unavoidable ramifications. What would I have done? Hopefully, I'd have asked for a dot ball, so that everyone went back to where they began. That's easy for me to say. Until you feel the heat of the moment, experience the pressure and transmit the tension of the situation – and I haven't, thankfully – you don't really know what you would do.

It was interesting that the MCC should make a point of publicly criticizing the Ashwin incident in this year's IPL as being against the spirit of the game. They stage an annual lecture, originally named in honour of Colin Cowdrey, in which characters as diverse as Desmond Tutu, Geoffrey Boycott, Beefy Botham, Kumar Sangakkara, Brendon McCullum and Brian Lara have outlined their thoughts and philosophies.

That is staged at Lord's, landing ground for the helicopter that ferried Allen Stanford, self-styled saviour of world cricket, and crates containing a supposed stash of $20 million in banknotes. He was welcomed gushingly by the ECB hierarchy, including Giles Clarke and David Collier, who